

SUBMISSION-QUALITY KNOWLEDGE HUB

CTD Module 3 Completeness Self-Audit

A section-by-section self-check for the CMC / quality dossier

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Version 1.0 · Content current as of June 2026. FDA guidance changes — verify against the latest sources before relying on this guide.

Independent educational resource — please read

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How to use this self-audit

Module 3 is the quality (CMC) heart of an ANDA: drug substance (3.2.S), drug product (3.2.P), appendices (3.2.A), and regional information (3.2.R). FDA analyses of first-cycle ANDA assessments show that quality / CMC issues — led by manufacturing/facility, then drug product, then drug substance — are a leading source of major deficiencies. Completeness will not, by itself, win a review, but missing or disorganized sections invite avoidable deficiencies and delay.

Where major quality deficiencies cluster

In a published FDA analysis of first-cycle major Complete Response Letters (FY2023 data), the quality disciplines most often raising major deficiencies were manufacturing (largely facility-related) ~31%, drug product ~27%, and drug substance ~9%. Prioritize your self-audit accordingly: facilities and drug product first.

Work top to bottom. An unchecked box is a gap to close before filing.

3.2.S — Drug Substance

3.2.S.1 General Information

- ☐ Nomenclature, structure, and general properties provided.

3.2.S.2 Manufacture

- ☐ Manufacturer(s) identified with addresses matching Form 356h.
- ☐ Manufacturing process and controls described; critical steps and intermediates defined.
- ☐ Valid DMF reference with authorized, current Letter of Authorization (if API sourced via DMF).

3.2.S.3 Characterisation

- ☐ Elucidation of structure and discussion of potential impurities provided.

3.2.S.4 Control of Drug Substance

- ☐ Specification, analytical procedures, and validation included; batch analyses provided.
- ☐ Impurity limits justified (qualification / toxicological justification where required).

3.2.S.5–3.2.S.7 Reference Standards, Container-Closure, Stability

- ☐ Reference standards described; container-closure for the substance defined.
- ☐ Stability data and post-approval stability commitment provided.

3.2.P — Drug Product

3.2.P.1 Description and Composition

- ☐ Dosage form and complete quantitative composition (per unit) provided; function of each excipient stated.

3.2.P.2 Pharmaceutical Development

- ☐ Formulation development described; comparative dissolution vs. RLD and excipient compatibility addressed.

3.2.P.3 Manufacture

- ☐ Manufacturer(s) and addresses match Form 356h; batch formula and process described.
- ☐ Process controls, critical steps, and process validation (or protocol/commitment) included.
- ☐ Executed/representative batch records for bio and stability batches provided.

3.2.P.4 Control of Excipients

- ☐ Specifications and analytical procedures for each excipient; compendial status noted; human/animal-origin and elemental-impurity considerations addressed.

3.2.P.5 Control of Drug Product

- ☐ Release and shelf-life specifications justified; analytical procedures validated; batch analyses and impurity characterization provided.
- ☐ Comparative dissolution data and f2 similarity (where applicable) included.

3.2.P.6–3.2.P.8 Reference Standards, Container-Closure, Stability

- ☐ Reference standards and container-closure system (with suitability data) described.
- ☐ Stability data covers required conditions/time points to support requested shelf life; protocol and commitment stated; photostability where applicable.

3.2.A & 3.2.R — Appendices and Regional Information

- ☐ Facilities and equipment appendix (3.2.A.1) consistent with Form 356h and Module 3 manufacturer sections.
- ☐ Adventitious agents safety evaluation (3.2.A.2) where applicable.
- ☐ Elemental impurities risk assessment / control strategy addressed.
- ☐ Regional information (3.2.R) complete: executed batch records, comparability protocols, and other U.S.-specific items as required.

Cross-document consistency (the high-yield final pass)

Most avoidable Module 3 problems are not missing science — they are mismatches. Before filing, reconcile:

- ☐ Every facility in 3.2.S.2 / 3.2.P.3 / 3.2.A.1 appears on Form 356h with identical name, address, FEI, and DUNS.
- ☐ Strengths, dosage form, and composition are identical across 3.2.P.1, labeling, and the application form.
- ☐ Specifications cited in the body match the actual specification tables and certificates of analysis.
- ☐ RLD identification is consistent across Module 3, BE, and labeling.
- ☐ Stability claims support the exact expiry requested on the label.

Self-audit sign-off

All 3.2.S, 3.2.P, 3.2.A, and 3.2.R boxes checked, with section locations recorded.

Cross-document consistency pass completed by a second reviewer.

A dated copy of this completed self-audit is saved to the submission archive.

Sources & further reading

This guide draws on the following publicly available FDA materials and regulations. Always confirm you are using the current version.

- ANDA Submissions — Content and Format (Guidance for Industry) — <https://www.finnegan.com/a/web/204676/FDA-Final-Guidance-ANDA-Content-and-Format.pdf>
- Common Quality Major Deficiencies in ANDAs (FDA, GDF 2025) — source of the 31% / 27% / 9% first-cycle figures — <https://www.fda.gov/media/187321/download>
- Analysis of Common ANDA Major Deficiencies (FDA, GDF 2025) — <https://www.fda.gov/media/187318/download>
- ICH M4Q (CTD — Quality) and ICH guidance on Module 3 organization — <https://www.fda.gov/regulatory-information/search-fda-guidance-documents>